Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam

MGU-UGP(Honours)

Fifth Semester Examination

(2024 Admission Onwards)

MG5DSCENG300– AMERICAN LITERATURE

Duration: 2 Hours Maximum Marks: 70

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Learning domains	Understand (U), Appreciate (Ap), and Evaluate (E)
Course Outcomes	CO1, CO2, CO3 and CO4

PART A

Multiple Choice Questions

Answer All Questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. Which American poet carried out formal and typographic experiments?
   a. e. e. cummings
   b. Hilda Doolittle
   c. Ezra Pound
   d. Robert Frost

[U] [CO1]

2. What is the central contrast in “O Captain! My Captain!”?
   a. War and peace
   b. Victory and mourning
   c. Youth and old age
   d. Freedom and slavery

[Ap] [CO2]

3. All works of the highest art are meant to _____.

   a. tingle our senses
   b. stir our intellect
   c. restore our skill for the art
   d. stir in us the sense of art

[U] [CO1]

4. According to Mark Twain, it is our nature to _____.

   a. refuse
   b. reject
   c. confirm
   d. conform

[U] [CO1]

5. What does the title “Harlem” primarily refer to?
   a. A character’s name

b. The historically Black neighbourhood in New York City that became the cultural centre of African-American life
c. A type of dream
d. A river in Africa

[Ap] [CO2]

6. According to Frost, what causes gaps to appear in the wall?
   a. Human activity alone
   b. Animals destroying it
   c. Natural forces such as frost
   d. Heavy rainfall

[Ap] [CO2]

7. How old is Chris Keller?
   a. 50 years
   b. 40 years
   c. 70 years
   d. Nearing 60

[U] [CO4]

8. Which is the most famous play of Arthur Miller?
   a. The Old Man and the Sea
   b. Pygmalion
   c. Death of a Salesman
   d. None of these

[U] [CO4]

9. Which interpretation best evaluates the old man's "vulture eye"?
   a. It represents beauty
   b. It functions as a psychological trigger for the narrator
   c. It proves that the old man is supernatural
   d. It symbolises wealth alone

[E] [CO3]

10. The ticking watch primarily symbolises:
    a. period technology
    b. comic relief
    c. escape planning
    d. mechanical inevitability of death

[E] [CO3]

[10 x 1 = 10]

PART B
SHORT ANSWER
Answer any 6 Questions. Each question carries 5 marks.

11. Evaluate Mama's decision to give the quilts to Maggie instead of Dee. [E] [CO3]
12. What secret does Kate Keller try to gatekeep in the drama? Explain. [E] [CO4]
13. Analyse how Dickinson establishes the tension between the ordinariness of nature and the extraordinary human experience of death in the opening stanza. [Ap] [CO2]
14. Evaluate the significance of the title *All My Sons*. [E][C04]

15. Why is the wind described as one who "knows the origin of this universe" in the poem "Remember"? [Ap] [CO2]
16. Attempt a character appreciation of Chris Keller. [E][C04]
17. Write a note on modernism in American literature. [U][CO1]
18. What does Emerson mean by the statement "Pictures must not be too picturesque."? [U][CO1]
19. The narrator of *The Tell-Tale Heart* is more guilty than mad. Evaluate. [E] [CO3]

[5x6=30]

PART C
ESSAY
Answer any 2 questions. The question carries 15 marks

20. Describe the early life of Booker T. Washington in the American South. [U] [CO1]
21. Evaluate how the symbolic images in Walt Whitman's *"*O Captain! My Captain!*"* deepen the poem's portrayal of victory, loss, and mourning. [Ap] [CO2]
22. Appreciate the play *All My Sons* as a work that explores the theme of American Dream. [E] [CO4]
23. Evaluate how Hemingway presents power dynamics in Harry and Helen's marriage. [E] [CO3]

[15x2=30]